GREEK ARMS

Early armour was bronze but was later exchanged for cheaper, lighter, linen armour which afforded quicker movement as battle tactics changed. Appearance would have mattered as well as strength, as some standoffs could result in simply visually intimidating the enemy into conceding defeat without going to battle. The primary and secondary weapon of the hoplite was the *doru* or spear. If the front half of the spear broke off in the crush of the battlefield the hoplite could still utilize the heavier butt of the spear, which was also equipped with a point.

Horsehair crest in natural whites or browns

Corinthian helmet
Increased manoeuvring during battle called for better communication, reflected in the design of this 400 BCE replica, allowing better hearing and visibility than earlier versions.

Larger eye holes for increased peripheral vision

Ear hole for responding to commands

Chiton
This was worn under the armour and would have been brightly dyed. Favoured military colours were red and blue.

Braiding prevented fraying on stitching

Yoke

Dyed linen

Bronze scales

Decorative strip level with hoplite's navel

Kopis ("chopper")
A scythe weapon developed from agriculture, the *kopis* was used in a hacking motion.

Solid bone grip

Leather sheath

Doru (spear)
A stabbing rather than throwing spear, the point or *aichme* was the primary stabbing weapon. The butt end was called the *sarouter* or "lizard sticker", as it was used to skewer fallen enemies. The hand-turned ash shaft was about 2–3m (7–9ft) long.

Iron *aichme* with central ridge for strength

SPEAR POINT

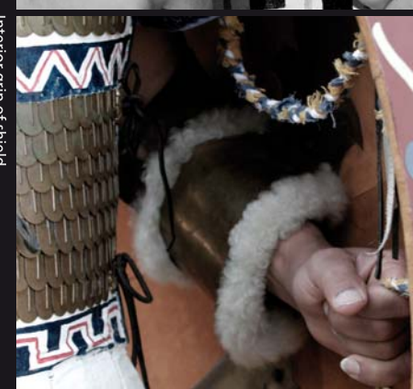
Ash shaft

SPEAR BUTT

Square-sectioned bronze *sarouter* at rear end of spear



Doing up leather fastenings



Interior grip of shield



Linothorax fastened on lefthand side